

SANTOS ECHEVARRIA

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September 5, 2026

Hiring Manager
THE COLLECTION
Coral Gables, FL

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Finance and Insurance Manager position at THE COLLECTION.

Let me start with the obvious. Your posting asks for five years of luxury automotive experience as an F&I Manager. I do not have it. What I have is thirty-three years as a finance manager in South Florida — twenty-eight at Bill Seidle Nissan Auto Group, eight before that at Brickell Honda — all of it in volume franchise stores. I am applying anyway, and I would rather tell you that myself than have you find it on the first page of my résumé.

Here is what I would bring to each part of the role as you have described it.

- **Finance and insurance operations.** Thirty-three years structuring finance and lease deals — calculating terms, taxes, rates, and fees; presenting warranties, GAP, and protection plans; and securing approvals through lender relationships built across banks, captives, and credit unions over decades, for customers at every point on the credit spectrum. Six-time winner of the Nissan Award of Excellence, and Platinum level in Nissan Security Plus products every year since 2005. Those are the manufacturer's figures on my performance, not my own.
- **Customer experience.** I have spent my career in a market where whether a customer came back — and whether their family did — turned on whether they trusted the person in the finance office. I supported a fifteen-person sales team and trained them on the hand-off into my office so that transition never cost us the client's confidence. Transparency is not something I would be adjusting to. It is a large part of why I have been at one store for twenty-eight years.
- **Compliance and reporting.** Truth in Lending, the Fair Credit Reporting Act and the Red Flags Rule, OFAC — thousands of funded deals, clean documentation, and a clean record. I have handled customer credit information under those obligations every working day for three decades, and I have accounted for my penetration and performance figures to both dealership management and a manufacturer that follows its numbers closely.

On the practical points: I am available for evenings, weekends, holidays, and off-site events, and I work in CDK, DealerTrack, and Reynolds & Reynolds daily, so there would be no learning curve on your systems.

What I cannot tell you is that I have written a deal for a Ferrari client. What I can tell you is that a high-net-worth buyer's expectations are not merely different from what I know — they are higher. Faster, more discreet, better prepared, with no wasted minutes. After thirty-three years I know precisely how a finance office earns that standard, and how it loses it. If you are open to someone who would be learning your clientele while bringing three decades of everything else, I would welcome the chance to sit down and go through my numbers with you.

Sincerely,

Santos Echevarria